

Strings in PHP

5.1 Introduction to string

We have already discussed the basics of strings in PHP. Here we will look at some of the advanced features of strings.

We can use the concatenation operator (.) to concatenate two strings. Look at the example below:

Example:

```
<?php
$text1 = "Welcome";
$text2 = "abcd";
echo $text1 . " " . $text2;
?>
```

The output of this program is as follows:

Welcome abcd

Here, we have used the concatenation operator twice to insert another (third) string. We have inserted a string that includes a single character just between the two string variables. Here, we have used an empty space to separate the two variables.

Variables are parsed within the strings if it is inserted within double quotation marks or in the Heredoc strings. Here we have two types of syntax:

Simple: The simple syntax is most commonly used in PHP. We cannot parse an array value or an object property in a variable by using this syntax.

Complex: PHP4 has introduced complex syntax. It is always inserted within curly braces.

Simple:

When the PHP engine executes a dollar sign(\$), then the parser will receive a number token to develop a valid variable name. That is why we need to insert the names of the variables in curly braces